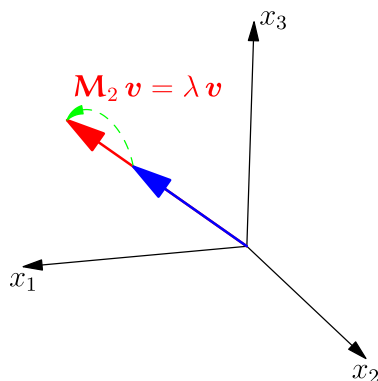
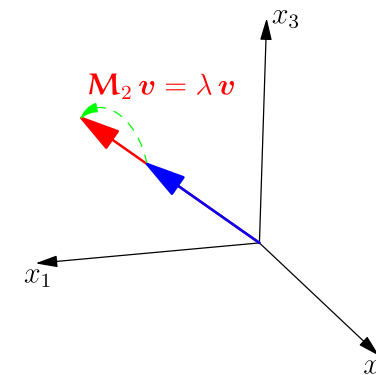


Eigensystems



Eigenvectors, Orthogonal Matrices, Eigenvector Decomposition, Rank

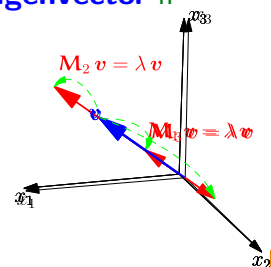
1. **Eigenvectors**
2. Orthogonal Matrices
3. Eigen Decomposition
4. Low Rank Approximation
5. Non-Normal Matrices



Eigenvector equation

- Eigen-systems help us to understand mappings
- A non-zero vector v is said to be an **eigenvector** if

$$Mv = \lambda v$$



- M is square (i.e. $n \times n$)
- Where the number λ is the **eigenvalue**
- Eigenvalues play a fundamental role in understanding operators

Symmetric Matrices

- If M is an $n \times n$ **symmetric** matrix then it has n real orthogonal eigenvectors with real eigenvalues
- We denote the i^{th} eigenvector by v_i and the corresponding eigenvalue by λ_i so that

$$Mv_i = \lambda_i v_i$$

- Orthogonal means that if $i \neq j$ then

$$v_i^T v_j = 0$$

- (We can always normalise eigenvectors if we want)

Proof of Orthogonality

- $(\mathbf{M}v_i = \lambda_i v_i)^\top$ implies $v_i^\top \mathbf{M}^\top = \lambda_i v_i^\top$
- When $\mathbf{M}$ is symmetric then $\mathbf{M}v_i = \lambda_i v_i \Rightarrow v_i^\top \mathbf{M} = \lambda_i v_i^\top$
- Consider two eigenvectors v_i and v_j of $\mathbf{M}$

$$\begin{aligned} v_i^\top \mathbf{M} v_j &= (v_i^\top \mathbf{M}) v_j = \lambda_i v_i^\top v_j \\ &= v_i^\top (\mathbf{M} v_j) = \lambda_j v_i^\top v_j \end{aligned}$$

- So either $\lambda_i = \lambda_j$ or $v_i^\top v_j = 0$
- If $\lambda_i = \lambda_j$ then any linear combination of v_i and v_j is an eigenvector $(\mathbf{M}(av_i + bv_j) = \lambda_i(av_i + bv_j))$. So I can choose two eigenvectors that are orthogonal to each other.

Orthogonal Matrices

- We can construct an **orthogonal** matrix $\mathbf{V}$ from the normalised eigenvectors ($v_i^\top v_i = 1$)

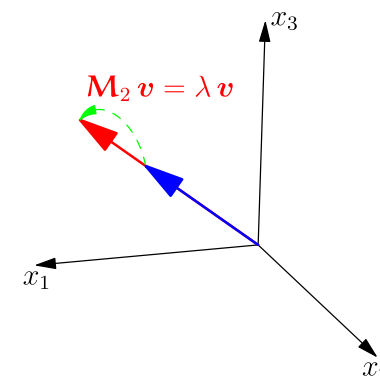
$$\mathbf{V} = (v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n)$$

- Matrix $\mathbf{V}$ is an $n \times n$ matrix
- Because the vectors v_i are orthogonal and normalised

$$\mathbf{V}^\top \mathbf{V} = \begin{pmatrix} v_1^\top v_1 & v_1^\top v_2 & \dots & v_1^\top v_n \\ v_2^\top v_1 & v_2^\top v_2 & \dots & v_2^\top v_n \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ v_n^\top v_1 & v_n^\top v_2 & \dots & v_n^\top v_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & \dots & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & \dots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \dots & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{I}$$

Outline

1. Eigenvectors
2. **Orthogonal Matrices**
3. Eigen Decomposition
4. Low Rank Approximation
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The Other Way Around

- We have shown that $\mathbf{V}^\top \mathbf{V} = \mathbf{I}$
- Thus multiply both sides on the left by $\mathbf{V}$

$$\mathbf{V} \mathbf{V}^\top \mathbf{V} = \mathbf{V} \mathbf{I}$$

- $\mathbf{V}$ will have an inverse (we show this on the next slide), $\mathbf{V}^{-1}$, such that $\mathbf{V} \mathbf{V}^{-1} = \mathbf{I}$
- Multiplying the equation on the right by $\mathbf{V}^{-1}$

$$\begin{aligned} (\mathbf{V} \mathbf{V}^\top) \mathbf{V} \mathbf{V}^{-1} &= \mathbf{V} \mathbf{V}^{-1} \mathbf{I} \\ \mathbf{V} \mathbf{V}^\top &= \mathbf{I} \end{aligned}$$

- Note that, $\mathbf{V}^{-1} = \mathbf{V}^\top$ (definition of orthogonal matrix)

Invertible Matrices

- A matrix, $\mathbf{M}$, will be singular (not invertible) if there exists a vector $\mathbf{x} (\neq \mathbf{0})$ such that

$$\mathbf{M}\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{0}$$

- Now if there exists such a vector such that $\mathbf{V}\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{0}$ then multiplying by $\mathbf{V}^T$ we get

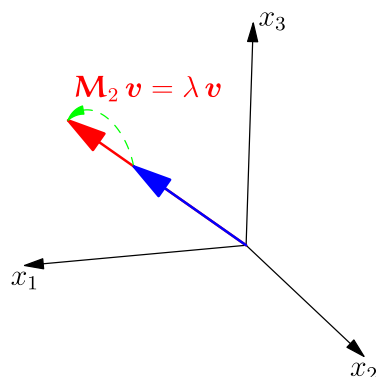
$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{V}^T\mathbf{V}\mathbf{x} &= \mathbf{V}^T\mathbf{0} \\ \mathbf{x} &= \mathbf{0}\end{aligned}$$

since $\mathbf{V}^T\mathbf{V} = \mathbf{I}$

- Thus $\mathbf{V}$ is invertible

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Rotations

- Orthogonal matrices satisfy $\mathbf{V}^T\mathbf{V} = \mathbf{V}\mathbf{V}^T = \mathbf{I}$
- As a consequence they define rotations (and possibly a reflection)
- Consider a vector $\mathbf{x}$ and $\mathbf{x}' = \mathbf{V}\mathbf{x}$, now

$$\|\mathbf{x}'\|_2^2 = \mathbf{x}'^T\mathbf{x}' = (\mathbf{V}\mathbf{x})^T(\mathbf{V}\mathbf{x}) = \mathbf{x}^T\mathbf{V}^T\mathbf{V}\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{x}^T\mathbf{x} = \|\mathbf{x}\|_2^2$$

- Similarly if additionally $\mathbf{y}' = \mathbf{V}\mathbf{y}$ then

$$\langle \mathbf{x}', \mathbf{y}' \rangle = (\mathbf{V}\mathbf{x})^T(\mathbf{V}\mathbf{y}) = \mathbf{x}^T\mathbf{V}^T\mathbf{V}\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{x}^T\mathbf{y} = \langle \mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y} \rangle = \|\mathbf{x}\|_2\|\mathbf{y}\|_2\cos(\theta)$$

- Rotations and reflections preserve lengths and angles

Matrix Decomposition

- Taking the matrix of eigenvectors, $\mathbf{V}$, then

$$\mathbf{M}\mathbf{V} = \mathbf{M}(\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n) = (\lambda_1\mathbf{v}_1, \lambda_2\mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \lambda_n\mathbf{v}_n) = \mathbf{V}\mathbf{\Lambda}$$

- where $\mathbf{\Lambda} = \text{diag}(\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \dots, \lambda_n) = \begin{pmatrix} \lambda_1 & 0 & \dots & 0 \\ 0 & \lambda_2 & \dots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \dots & \lambda_n \end{pmatrix}$

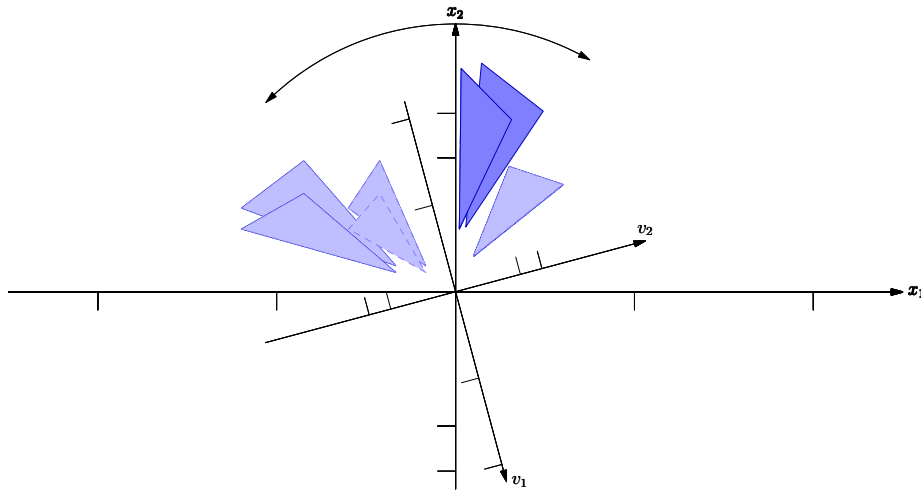
- Now

$$\mathbf{M} = \mathbf{M}\mathbf{V}\mathbf{V}^T = \mathbf{V}\mathbf{\Lambda}\mathbf{V}^T$$

- Very important *similarity transform*

Mappings by Symmetric Matrices

$$\mathbf{M} = \begin{pmatrix} 0.83 & -0.31 \\ -0.31 & 1.9 \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{V}\mathbf{\Lambda}\mathbf{V}^T = \begin{pmatrix} \cos(-75) & \sin(-75) \\ -\sin(-75) & \cos(-75) \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0.75 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \cos(75) & \sin(75) \\ -\sin(75) & \cos(75) \end{pmatrix}$$



Inverses

- For any symmetric invertible matrix

$$\mathbf{M} = \mathbf{V}\mathbf{\Lambda}\mathbf{V}^T \quad \mathbf{M}^{-1} = \mathbf{V}\mathbf{\Lambda}^{-1}\mathbf{V}^T$$

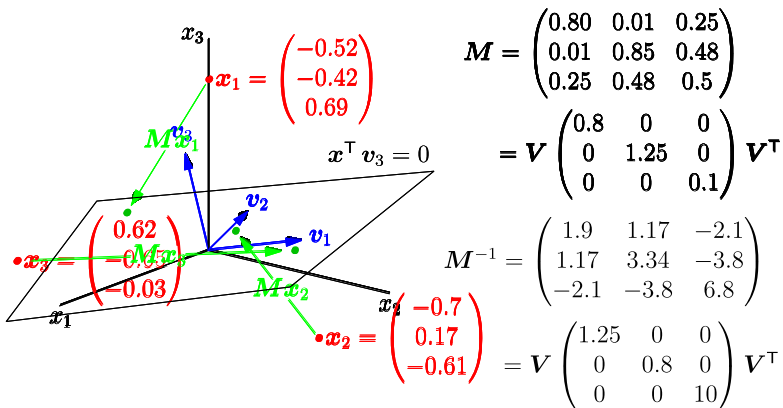
- Where $\mathbf{\Lambda}^{-1} = \text{diag}(\frac{1}{\lambda_1}, \frac{1}{\lambda_2}, \dots, \frac{1}{\lambda_n}) = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{\lambda_1} & 0 & \dots & 0 \\ 0 & \frac{1}{\lambda_2} & \dots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \dots & \frac{1}{\lambda_n} \end{pmatrix}$

- Since

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{M}\mathbf{M}^{-1} &= (\mathbf{V}\mathbf{\Lambda}\mathbf{V}^T)(\mathbf{V}\mathbf{\Lambda}^{-1}\mathbf{V}^T) = \mathbf{V}\mathbf{\Lambda}(\mathbf{V}^T\mathbf{V})\mathbf{\Lambda}^{-1}\mathbf{V}^T \\ &= \mathbf{V}\mathbf{\Lambda}\mathbf{\Lambda}^{-1}\mathbf{V}^T = \mathbf{V}\mathbf{V}^T = \mathbf{I} \end{aligned}$$

- i.e. small eigenvalues become large eigenvalues and vice versa

Ill-Conditioning Again



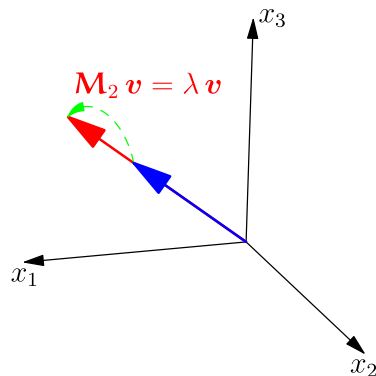
Condition Number

- Taking matrix inverses can be inherently unstable
- Any small error can be amplified by taking the inverse
- The stability of the inverse depends on the ratio of smallest eigenvalue to the largest eigenvalue (i.e. the biggest possible amplification compared to the smallest)
- For symmetric matrices the largest $|\lambda|$ is the spectral norm, $\|\mathbf{M}\|_2$, from the vector spaces lecture
- The condition number is given by

$$\|\mathbf{M}\|_2 \times \|\mathbf{M}^{-1}\|_2 = \frac{|\lambda_{\max}|}{|\lambda_{\min}|}$$

- Large condition number implies very ill-conditioned

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“Inverting” Rank Deficient Matrices

- Rank deficient matrices are non-invertible (i.e. we don't know the vector x such that $Mx = b$) as we don't know the component of the x in the null space
- Although we don't know x we can find a vector, x , that satisfies $Mx = b$ (provided one exists)
- Given a symmetric $n \times n$ matrix with k non-zero eigenvalues $\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \dots, \lambda_k$ we can construct a “pseudo-inverse” M^+ as $V\Lambda^+V^T$ where $\Lambda^+ = \text{diag}(\frac{1}{\lambda_1}, \frac{1}{\lambda_2}, \dots, \frac{1}{\lambda_k}, 0, \dots, 0)$
- This finds the vector x with no component in the null space (it is the solution with the smallest norm)
- This and $(X^TX)^{-1}X^T$ are special cases of the pseudo-inverse we meet with SVD

- The rank of a symmetric matrix, M , is the number of non-zero eigenvalues
- The space spanned by the eigenvectors v_a, v_b , etc. with zero eigenvalue forms a **null space**
- Any vector in the null space will get mapped to the zero vector

$$M(av_a + bv_b + \dots) = 0$$

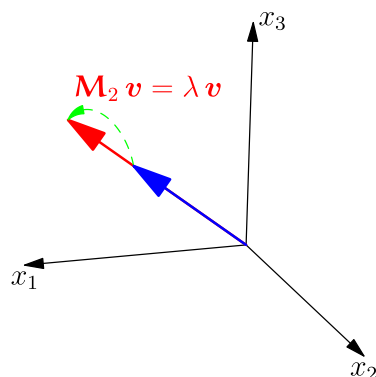
- A square matrix is said to be **rank deficient** if it has any eigenvectors with eigenvalue equal to 0
- This happens when the columns of the matrix are not linearly independent

Low Rank Approximation

- Recall that matrices with large and small eigenvalues are ill-conditioned so the inverse has the potential to greatly amplify any measurement error
- One work around is to set all small eigenvalues to zero and use the pseudo-inverse
- Setting small eigenvalues to zero reduces the rank of the matrix and is an example of a low rank approximation
- Low rank approximations are much used to obtain approximate models for arrays of data (we will revisit this when we look at SVD)

Outline

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Non-Normal Matrices

- Symmetric matrices are part of a class of matrices known as **normal matrices**, which satisfy $\mathbf{M}\mathbf{M}^\dagger = \mathbf{M}^\dagger\mathbf{M}$ (for real matrices $\mathbf{M}^\dagger = \mathbf{M}^\top$)
- Hermitian matrices, $\mathbf{H}$, are complex matrices that equal their conjugate transpose: $\mathbf{H} = (\mathbf{H}^\top)^* = \mathbf{H}^\dagger$
- Hermitian matrices are also normal; they are important in quantum theory, less so in machine learning
- Normal matrices are exactly those with a full set of orthonormal (possibly complex) eigenvectors
- Most non-symmetric real matrices are not normal (rotations are an exception); their eigenvectors are more confusing

Asymmetric Matrices

- For $n \times n$ real symmetric matrices we are guaranteed there are n orthogonal real eigenvectors
- For non-symmetric matrices the eigenvectors will generally not be orthogonal, they won't necessarily be real
- We are not even guaranteed there will be n linearly independent eigenvectors
- Matrices which don't have n linearly independent eigenvectors are said to be **defective**, e.g. $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$ has only one
- Randomly generated matrices will typically not be defective, but nevertheless they can arise in certain situations

Characteristic Equation

- Since our eigenvectors are defined by $\mathbf{M}\mathbf{v} = \lambda\mathbf{v}$ then $(\mathbf{M} - \lambda\mathbf{I})\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{0}$ has a solution $\mathbf{v} \neq \mathbf{0}$ only if $\det(\mathbf{M} - \lambda\mathbf{I}) = 0$
- This is known as the characteristic equation and leads to an n^{th} order polynomial in λ
- An n^{th} order polynomial has n roots (counting repeats), which are in general complex
- Thus even for real (non-symmetric) matrices we can get complex eigenvalues

Complex Conjugate Pairs

- If $\mathbf{M}$ is real and λ is complex then $\mathbf{v}$ must be complex too, otherwise $\mathbf{M}\mathbf{v}$ would be real but $\lambda\mathbf{v}$ would not

- Furthermore

$$\mathbf{M}\mathbf{v} = \lambda\mathbf{v} \quad \implies \quad \mathbf{M}\mathbf{v}^* = \lambda^*\mathbf{v}^*$$

- So that eigenvectors and their corresponding eigenvalues exist in complex conjugate pairs

Left and Right Eigenvectors

- For symmetric matrices if $\mathbf{v}$ is a right-hand eigenvector in the sense that $\mathbf{M}\mathbf{v} = \lambda\mathbf{v}$ then $\mathbf{v}^T$ is a left-hand eigenvector

$$\mathbf{v}^T \mathbf{M} = \lambda \mathbf{v}^T$$

- Earlier we used this property to show that the eigenvectors for symmetric matrices are orthogonal
- For asymmetric real matrices the left-hand eigenvectors $\mathbf{u}^T$ are different from the right-hand eigenvectors, although they share the same eigenvalues (they have the same characteristic equation)

$$\mathbf{M}\mathbf{v} = \lambda\mathbf{v} \quad \mathbf{u}^T \mathbf{M} = \lambda \mathbf{u}^T$$

- As before, $\mathbf{u}_i^T \mathbf{v}_j = 0$ if $\lambda_i \neq \lambda_j$, but in general $\mathbf{v}_i^T \mathbf{v}_j \neq 0$

Eigen-Decomposition

- For a non-symmetric matrix, $\mathbf{M}$, provided it is not defective, we can decompose the matrix as

$$\mathbf{M} = \mathbf{V}\mathbf{\Lambda}\mathbf{V}^{-1}$$

- $\mathbf{\Lambda}$ is a diagonal matrix of eigenvalues
- $\mathbf{V}$ is a matrix whose columns are the right-hand eigenvectors—in general it is not an orthogonal matrix
- $\mathbf{V}^{-1}$ is a matrix whose rows are the left-hand eigenvectors (scaled so that $\mathbf{u}_i^T \mathbf{v}_i = 1$)

Summary

- Linear mappings are commonly used in machine learning algorithms such as regression
- We can understand symmetric operators by looking at their eigenvectors
- Any symmetric matrix can be decomposed as $\mathbf{M} = \mathbf{V}\mathbf{\Lambda}\mathbf{V}^T$
 - ★ where $\mathbf{V}$ is an orthogonal matrix whose columns are the eigenvectors
 - ★ and $\mathbf{\Lambda}$ is a diagonal matrix of the eigenvalues
- This decomposition allows us to understand inverse mappings
- Non-symmetric matrices are more complex—we use the eigen-decomposition less because of this